



THINGS TO DO

Make a hexaflexagon



A hexaflexagon is an amazing paper toy that has 6 sides, 6 corners, 6 faces, and 6 colours. Each time you flex it, it folds in on itself and the colour changes. With a bit of practise, you can make all 6 colours appear. Find out how to make one on page 95.

Snow business

Hexagons are surprisingly common in nature. Snowflakes grow from hexagonal ice crystals, which is why they always have 6 arms – though every snowflake is slightly different. Bees store honey in a grid of hexagonal chambers called a honeycomb, and the eyes of insects are made of hexagonal lenses packed together. In some parts of the world, such as Giant's Causeway in Northern Ireland, you can even see hexagonal rocks.

hexagons
in nature

Packing together

The main reason hexagons are common in nature is that they form naturally when circular objects pack together. Take a pile of coins of equal size and push them together until they're as tightly packed as possible. You'll see hexagonal rings just like the honeycomb in a beehive.



Magic mirrors

Draw a thick black line across a piece of white paper and stand two small mirrors over the line at right angles. (If you don't have mirrors, use CD cases with black paper inside so they reflect light.) Look in the mirrors and you'll see a square. If you change the angle of the mirrors, you can make a triangle, pentagon, hexagon, and other polygons magically appear!